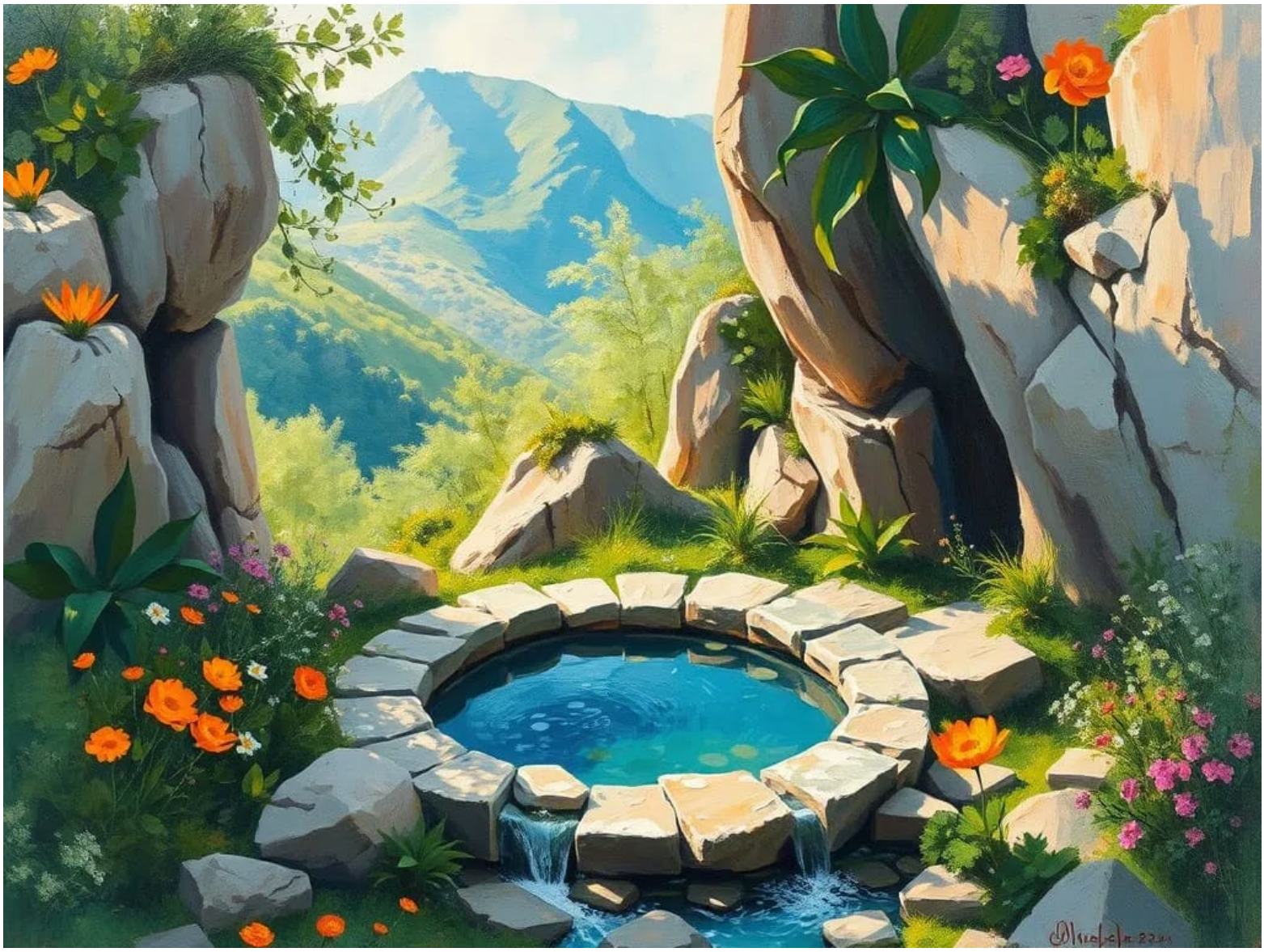
Project Seven: The Wildling Quest

By Chrissa Shamberger



Game Flow

Note: The illustrations in this paper, all of the Screen Backgrounds, the deer, the kingfisher, the boards (except for the settings page), are paintings by Chrissa Shamberger.

Screen List for 'The Wildling Quest Android Mobile Game App

Landing Page

Signup

Login

Main Menu

Multiplayer Mode Menu Options Screen

Character Selection

Splash title and logo

Splash immersion

Multiplay game start screen

Characters in the game sit appear as they are selected sitting around a campfire in the evening.

They need to decide to be a community. All for one and one for all.

players form a community with friends, is preparing for an adventure. They gather a group of like-minded adventurers (who can be controlled by other players in multiplayer mode) and decide to travel through Ontario, Canada, and help out some French-speaking Indigenous people who are in need.

Backyard screen (packing for trip)

Pack your backpack with essential items (food, tools, camping gear)
Learn basic French travel vocabulary (bicycle, tent, map, etc.)

Bike path in Ohio screen

Wilderness screen

Players learn by immersion –cook a campfire meal or gather wild edibles.

Not dark themes.

In the tree with bear underneath

****Mostly non-combat.**

lake areas screen

Players learn by immersion.

Fields screen

mountains screen

Mountain Town screen

Garden screen

**Vibrant Art and Colors: The art style will be bright, colorful, and artistic, featuring hand-drawn, painterly landscapes and charming, whimsical character designs. Players paint the garden.

Café Discussions with artists: (this could be at a campfire) Join the artists in a simulated café setting where players discuss art, philosophy, or cultural topics, expanding vocabulary with terms like *la créativité* or *les mouvements artistiques*.

Mix paint for the artist following their verbal directions screen

Kayacking screen

Build a treehouse screen

Visit from Bigfoot screen

Quests lists screen

Explore one

Animation

Explore two

Animation

Explore three

Animation

Explore four

Animation

Menu Screen

Achievements Page

Inventory

Map

Settings

Teacher Screen to view the classroom.

- **Classroom**
- Each group picks one of the 6 players.
- The teacher can see what each group is doing.

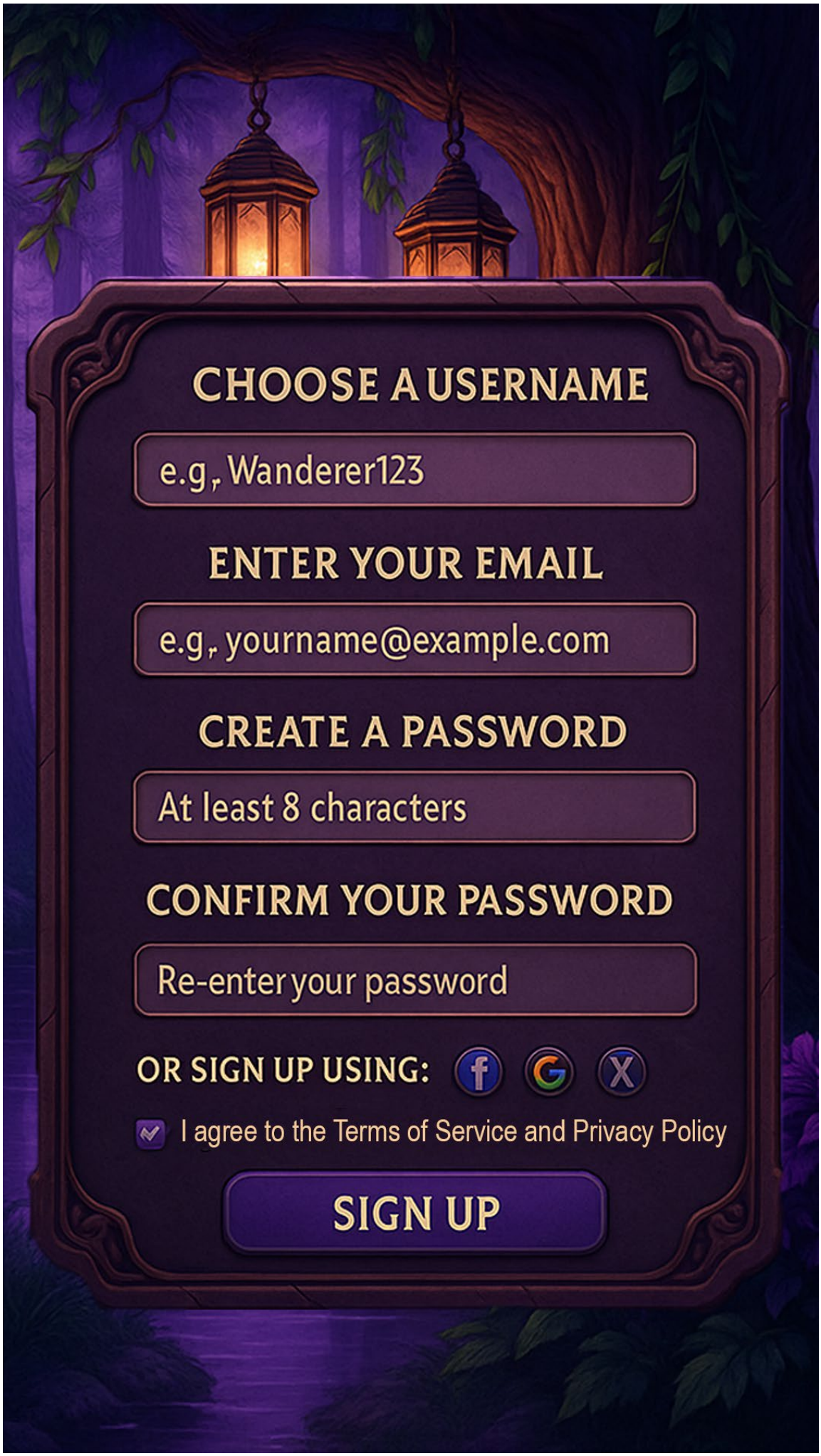
Landing Page for New Users



Landing page screen: The landing page introduces users to the app through an immersive visual and textual experience. Featuring a background graphic of a forest, field, and starlit sky, with a figure walking toward the woods, it immediately sets the tone for an open-world outdoor adventure. Key elements such as the title ('The Wildling Quest'), and the game type ('Open World Outdoor Adventure'), are presented in a visually striking hierarchy. Supporting text, the tagline, encourages users to embark on an exciting journey and learn French in a fun and interactive way. The design prioritizes immersion and storytelling to captivate users while conveying the app's features and purpose.

Sign up Screen

Sign up page (for new users after the landing page)


CHOOSE A USERNAME
e.g., Wanderer123
ENTER YOUR EMAIL
e.g., yourname@example.com
CREATE A PASSWORD
At least 8 characters
CONFIRM YOUR PASSWORD
Re-enter your password
OR SIGN UP USING:
I agree to the Terms of Service and Privacy Policy
SIGN UP

Sign-Up Screen (For New Users)

Purpose: Enable users to create an account and get started with the app.

This image could have swaying plants or fireflies.

A serene login screen, such as a twilight forest scene with pine trees, a glowing green moon, subtle animations like swaying plants or fireflies, and the warm glow of distant tents, is ideal for creating an inviting and engaging experience for players. The purpose of a login screen is to act as a gateway to the game, and choosing calming visuals helps ease players into the game world, reducing any potential stress or tension they might feel.

This tranquil design is particularly beneficial for a game aimed at language learners, as it provides a low-pressure entry point into the experience. By offering soothing imagery, it helps players feel welcome and encourages focus, preparing them mentally for the challenges and tasks ahead. The calm atmosphere reduces distractions, ensuring that the login interface remains functional while still setting the emotional tone of the game.

Additionally, a serene login screen maintains consistency with the immersive world-building of the game. It reinforces the narrative and visual style introduced in the splash screen, seamlessly drawing players deeper into the game's universe. This continuity not only strengthens engagement but also contributes to creating a memorable and cohesive experience for learners and players alike.

This design approach is not only visually impactful but also deeply aligned with educational principles that enhance language acquisition. Several key learning theories underscore the effectiveness of such a thoughtfully crafted login screen:

- **Affective Filter Hypothesis**: This hypothesis suggests that reducing learners' stress and anxiety improves their ability to acquire language. A serene login screen with calming visuals, such as twilight tones and gentle animations, creates a welcoming and low-pressure environment. This helps lower the affective filter, making learners more receptive to engaging with the game's content.

- **Cognitive Load Theory**: Ensuring that the login screen is visually appealing yet simple supports this theory. By limiting distractions and presenting an uncluttered interface, the design prevents cognitive overload, allowing learners to focus on the task at hand—logging in and beginning their learning journey.

- **Situated Learning Theory**: The visual elements of the login screen can subtly connect learners to the game's context. For instance, details like the trees and the asmosphere hint at practical, real-world scenarios learners might explore within the game. This primes them for contextual language learning, where they associate vocabulary and phrases with meaningful situations.

- **Constructivist Theory**: Constructivism emphasizes the importance of learners building their own understanding through experiences. The immersive login screen acts as the first step in engaging learners with the game's narrative, encouraging curiosity and exploration that aligns with constructivist principles.

- **Engagement Theory**: A beautifully designed login screen fosters emotional engagement, drawing learners into the game world and enhancing motivation. This connection sets the tone for sustained interaction with the game's educational content.

Tech: Automatic Navigation

If the game can intelligently detect the user's status:

- Existing users can be sent directly to the login screen.

- New users can go directly to the sign-up screen (e.g., via a prompt or detection of no prior account).

This is smoother and will require backend logic to identify the user's status (e.g., cookie or session tracking).

Tutorial Screen

(Players are directed from the sign up screen to the tutorial screen) (This is not included in my app screens to turn in)

Login Screen

(For returning users)

**Has social login options for seamless access

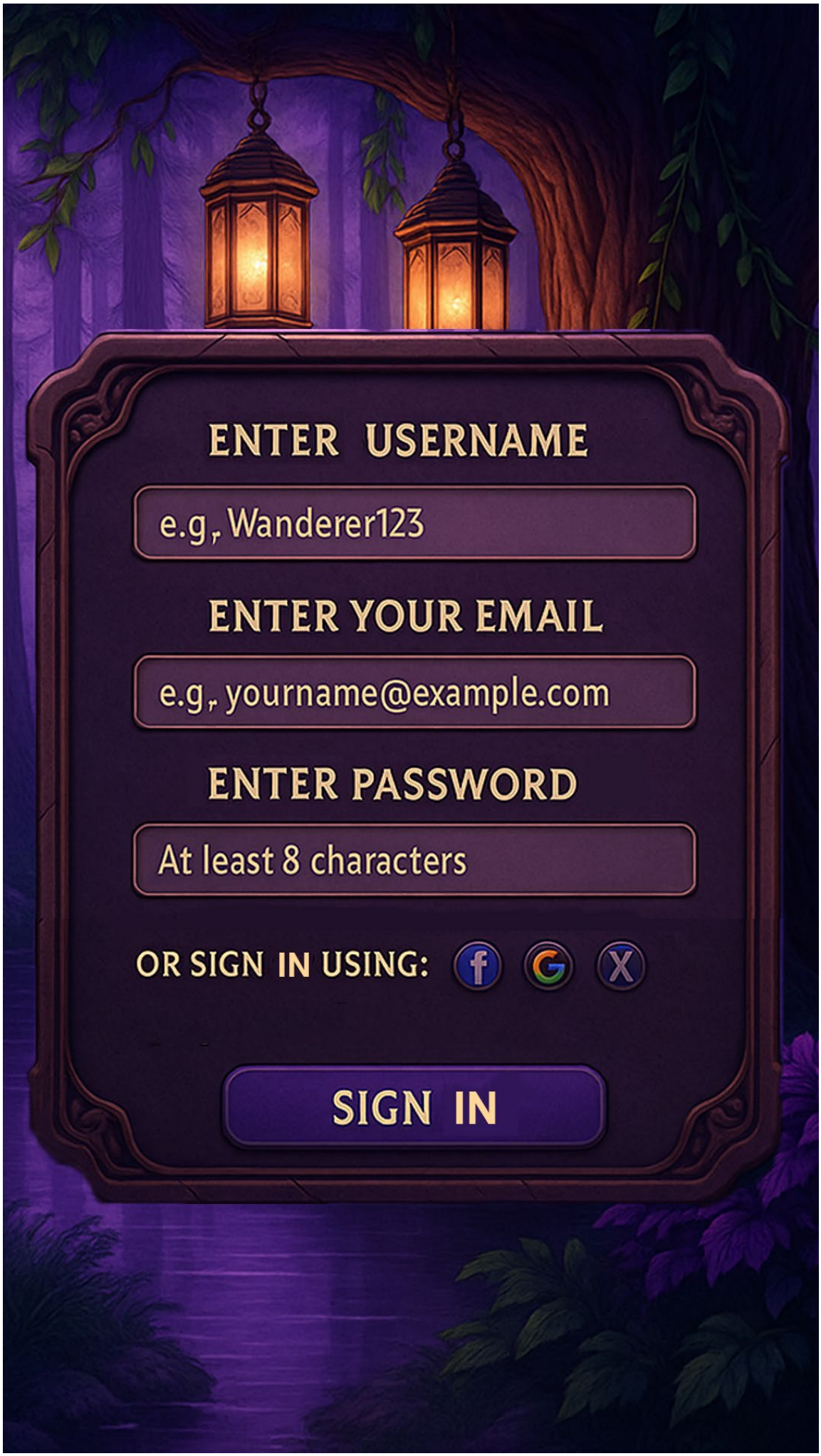
Login screen: The returning user logs in. The user can use dictation to log in to the app.

Fields: **Login Page (For Returning Users)**

Purpose: **Allow registered users to access their accounts.**

Additional Features:

5. **Forgot Password Link**
    - Label: *"Forgot Password?"*
    - Placement: Beneath the password field for visibility.
    - Redirects to the password recovery workflow.
    -
6. **Alternative Sign-Up Prompt**
    - Text: *"Don't have an account? Sign Up"*
    - Placement: At the bottom of the page with a clickable link to the Sign-Up Page.


ENTER USERNAME
e.g., Wanderer123
ENTER YOUR EMAIL
e.g., yourname@example.com
ENTER PASSWORD
At least 8 characters
OR SIGN IN USING:
SIGN IN

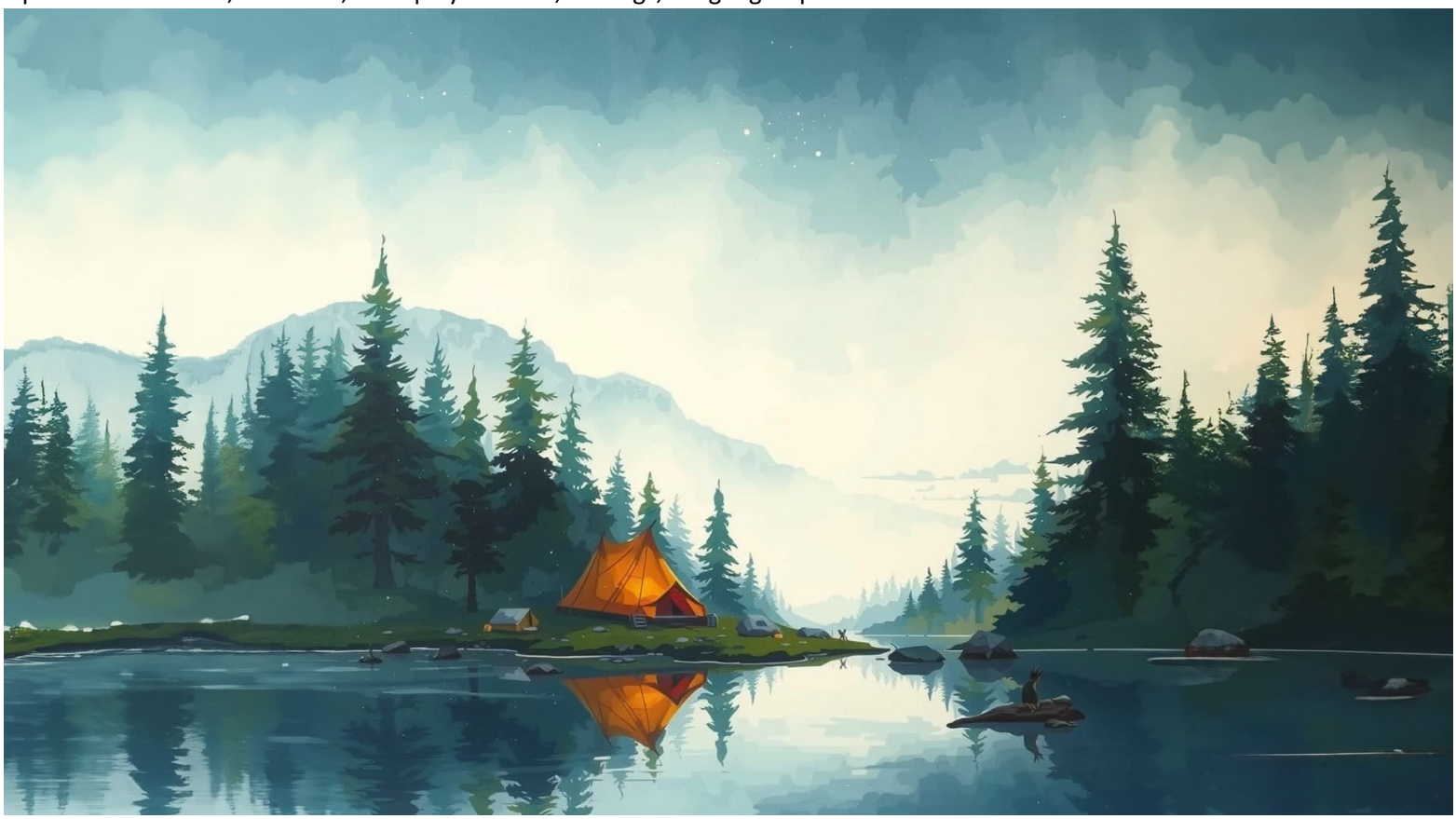
Main Screen

Main Menu Screen

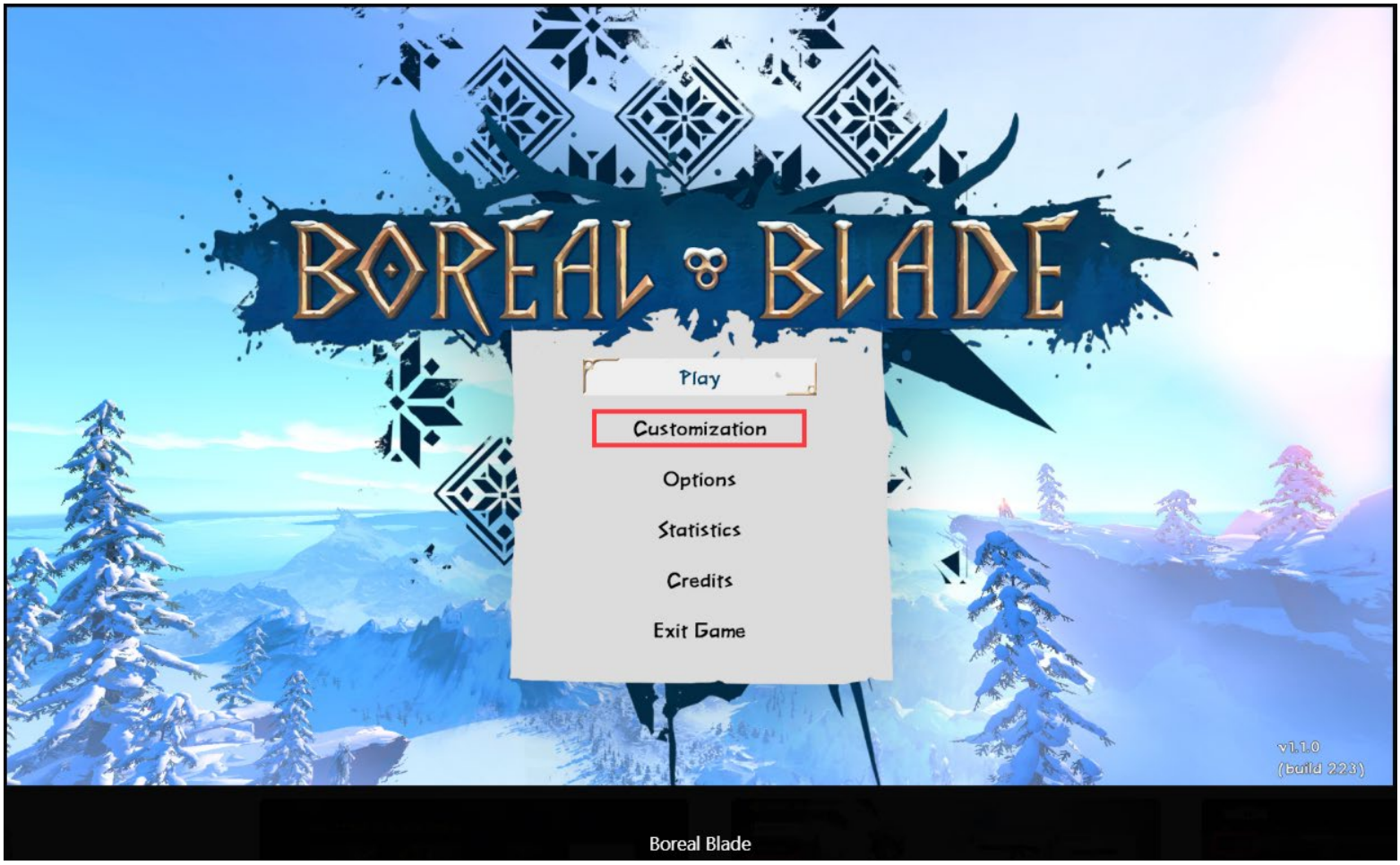
(After login, returning players are taken straight to the Main Menu Screen.)

(After completing the tutorial, new players are taken to the Main Menu screen.

Options: New Game, Continue, Multiplayer Mode, Settings, Language Options.







1. **Continue/Start Game:**
    - Label: *"Continue Your Quest"* for returning players.
    - Label: *"Start Your Wildling Adventure"* for new players.
    - Automatically resume where the player left off or begin the first quest for new users.

2. **Language Settings/Preferences:**
    - Label: *"Language Settings"* or *"Customize Your French Journey."*
    - Allow players to adjust difficulty, vocabulary focus, or learning pace.
3. **Multiplayer Mode:**
    - Button label: "Multiplayer Adventures".

4. **Customize Character:**

5. **World Map (if applicable):**
    - Label: *"Explore Wanderlight"* or *"World Map."*
    - Opens a map or navigation hub for players to dive into different regions.
6. **Profile/Account Settings:**
    - Label: *"Your Profile."*
    - Includes account management, avatar customization (if applicable), and progress stats.
7. **Tutorial/Help Center:**
    - Label: *"How to Play."*
    - Links to an interactive tutorial or tips for navigating the game and learning mechanics.
8. **Achievements/Quest Log (optional):**
    - Label: *"Your Achievements"* or *"Quest Progress."*
    - Displays completed milestones and upcoming goals to inspire engagement.
9. **Shop/Extras (optional):**
    - Label: *"Wildling Shop"* or *"Extras."*
    - Includes downloadable content (DLC), in-game purchases, or bonus content (if applicable).
10. **Logout Option (optional):**
    - Place in a menu or settings area for accessibility.

Other Design Elements for Main Screen

- **Tagline:** Include the tagline (e.g., *"Step into Wanderlight: Immerse yourself in French on your quest in the Wildling World"*) at the top or bottom as a gentle reminder of the game's theme.
- **Buttons:** Use visually distinct buttons with clear labels for each feature. Hover or click animations (e.g., glowing edges) can add polish.
- **Notifications:** If there's ongoing news (e.g., updates, new quests), consider a notification icon (like a small bell or exclamation mark).

Additional Features for Engagement (Optional) for Main Screen.

- **Daily Rewards:** Encourages players to return frequently.
- **Community Hub:** Links to a forum or social space to interact with other players (e.g., Discord).
- **Upcoming Events:** Display upcoming challenges or quests to build anticipation.

Splash Screen



Solves: Limitations of 3D art

Design Benefits:

Unlike 3D art, which can introduce readability issues, disrupt aesthetic consistency, trigger motion sickness, and demand more complex gameplay mechanics, this game embraces **beautiful 2D art** to create a visually cohesive, immersive, and accessible experience.

Setting the Tone: A Visual Invitation into the Story



Notes: The gentle sounds of the nighttime forest accompany subtle animations, including a few twinkling stars, a softly waving tail, and the occasional swaying leaf.

Solves: Lack of Immersion

Design Benefits:

This second splash screen immediately sets the tone for an immersive mobile game. Lush plants in the foreground and the subtle detail of rabbits add richness and life to the scene, gently drawing players into the game's world before gameplay even begins. This kind of visual storytelling sparks curiosity and invites exploration, helping to emotionally anchor the player in the experience.

Solves: Lack of Educational Theory in Design

Design Benefits:

Unlike *Life is Strange*, which was not designed for language learning, this game intentionally applies **proven educational theories** to enhance acquisition and retention.

One of the key design strategies used is **immersive game design**, which creates game environments and mechanics that fully engage players. This approach helps players feel like an integral part of the game world, making learning feel natural and enjoyable. The splash screen itself offers a glimpse into this design philosophy: by presenting a vibrant, detailed setting, it prepares players emotionally and cognitively for learning.

This design directly supports **immersive learning theory**, which emphasizes engaging multiple senses and forming emotional connections to boost memory and focus. The game's aesthetic and emotional tone increase motivation and create a sense of comfort—both of which are essential for effective language learning.

Another foundational concept in play is **the Affective Filter Hypothesis**, which addresses how emotions such as stress and anxiety can block language acquisition. When learners feel nervous or self-conscious, their ability to absorb new information decreases. By contrast, a calm, inviting splash screen can lower the affective filter. It establishes a welcoming, low-pressure environment that encourages players to take risks, try new words, and make mistakes without fear—key behaviors for language growth.

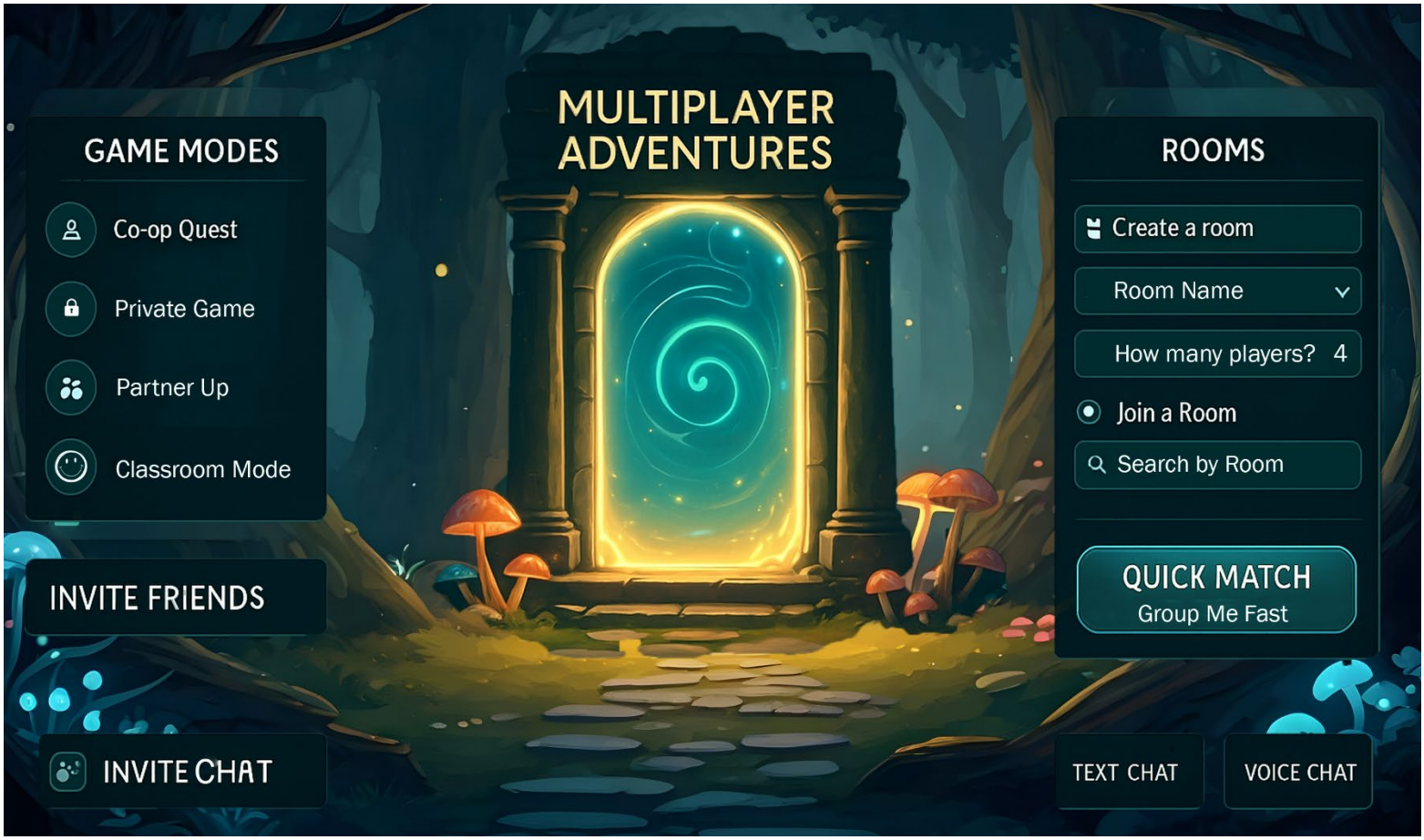
Finally, **Situated Learning Theory** is applied by embedding new vocabulary into a meaningful, context-rich environment. As players encounter and interact with objects like a “tent,” “forest,” or “moon,” they naturally associate words with their meanings. This mirrors real-world learning, where words are acquired through lived experience, not memorization.

Ultimately, the game’s immersive world **transforms language learning from an academic exercise into an organic, emotional experience**—bridging the gap between play and education in a way that *Life is Strange* was never designed to do.

Multiplayer Mode Menu Options Screen

Solves: Only one player can play.

Design Benefit: Introducing multiplayer functionality enhances social engagement and provides a collaborative gaming experience.



Packing for the Trip



There is some repetition, but the details are well-structured and important for explaining the game's mechanics and educational benefits. Here's a refined version that keeps all essential information while improving clarity and flow:

Solves: Traditional language learning apps often have static narratives where player choices do not influence the story.

Design Benefits:
In this game, player decisions meaningfully shape the narrative, deepening engagement and emotional investment. For example, the items players choose to pack for their trip directly affect their preparedness—neglecting essential items introduces challenges later in the gameplay.

This design draws inspiration from *Life is Strange*, a game known for its impactful decision-making. Unlike conventional language learning apps, this approach ensures that choices significantly affect the outcome, making the learning experience more immersive.

The **item selection mechanic** serves as both a storytelling driver and a language-learning tool. The packing list, presented entirely in French, encourages players to identify useful items based on their relevance to the game world. As players review and choose items, they naturally connect French vocabulary to context, reinforcing comprehension. Additionally, when players interact with objects in-game, their French names appear on-screen and are pronounced aloud, strengthening retention.

Selecting items supports language acquisition by:

- Increasing emotional engagement with the story
- Creating a more responsive and interactive world

- Encouraging exploration, leading to more language exposure
- Lowering stress (affective filter), which improves learning

By providing an exploratory, low-stakes environment, the game allows players to experiment freely without fear of judgment, reducing anxiety commonly associated with language learning. This approach aligns with established learning theories:

- **Self-Determination Theory (SDT):** Autonomy enhances intrinsic motivation
- **Constructivist Learning Theory:** Players actively build knowledge through real-world simulations
- **Situated Learning Theory:** Vocabulary gains meaning through contextual use (e.g., packing a *tent* for the forest)

Together, these elements reinforce the game's core value proposition: **learning French through meaningful, immersive adventure, guided by sound educational principles.**

Players Assist Canadian Artists (Group of Seven) by Painting a Garden

Solves: The existing 3D game art and pixel art RPGs is not engaging or especially interesting. The games using these art styles could be more aesthetically pleasing.

Design Benefits: Vibrant Art and Colors. The art style is bright, colorful, and artistic, featuring hand-drawn, painterly landscapes and charming, whimsical character designs.



Character Selection Screen

Solution: Players lack the ability to select an avatar.

Design Benefit: Empowering players to choose a character enhances personalization and engagement.



Escaping a Bear

Solves: Combat saturated.

Design Benefits: Our game embraces **immersive, non-combat interaction.**

Easy Mode Screen



Regular Mode Screen



The French used here is level A1 - A2.

Teacher Screen: For Classr

oom Use

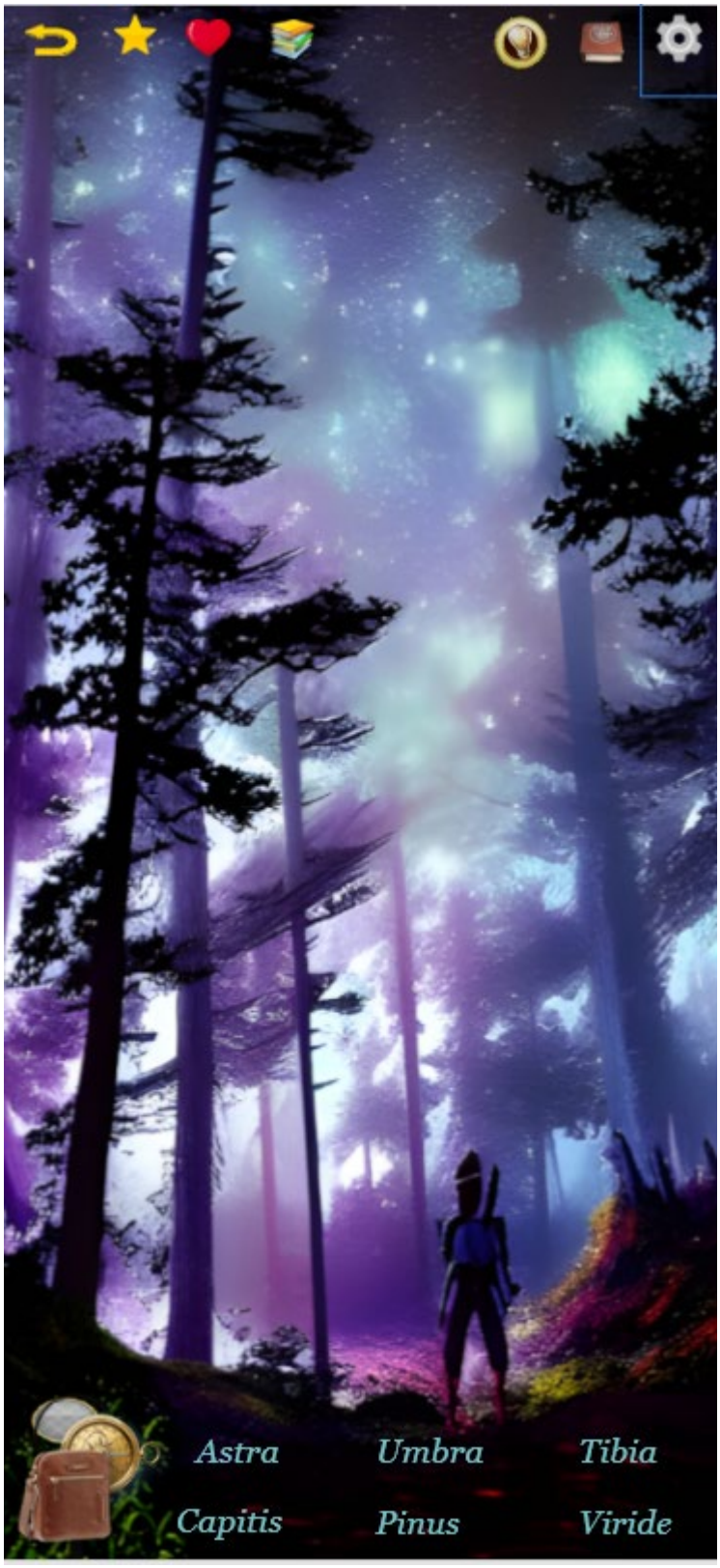
Solves: Not set up for classroom use.

Design Benefits: Our game has an educational mode for classroom integration.

A "teacher hub" for a 2D open-world game acts as a real-time learning analytics tool that provides teachers with a comprehensive overview of student activity within the game environment. It visually synthesizes data about student in-game actions to help teachers support individual and group learning.
The hub provides alerts for students who are struggling or making little progress, enabling teachers to intervene promptly.



Explore Screen 1



Explore screen: The quest begins. The player finds the hidden images and drags the word from the list of words onto the image. Then, both the object and the word go into the player's bag or inventory.

Animation



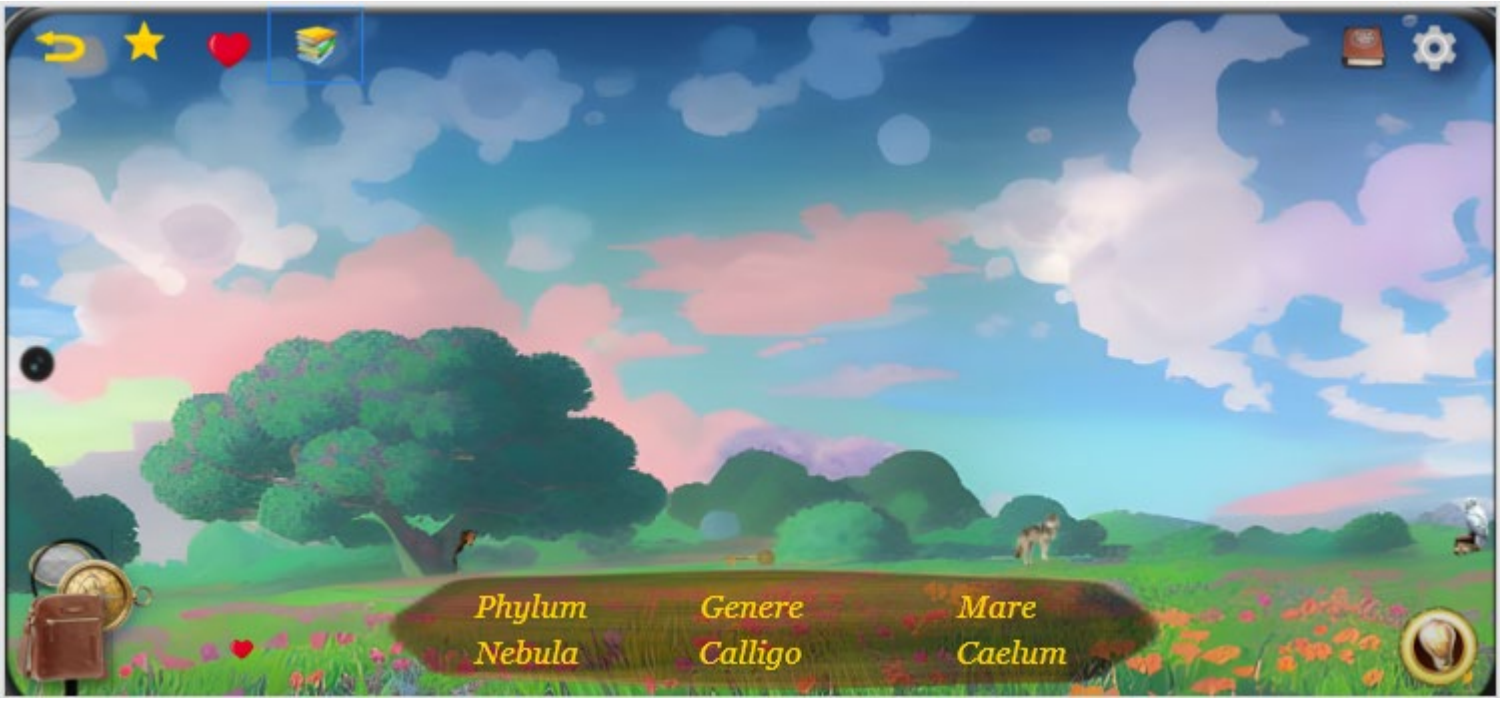
Animation Screen Shot: After all of the words are matched on Explore Screen 1, an animation plays that reviews all of the words from Explore Screen 1.

Explore Screen 2



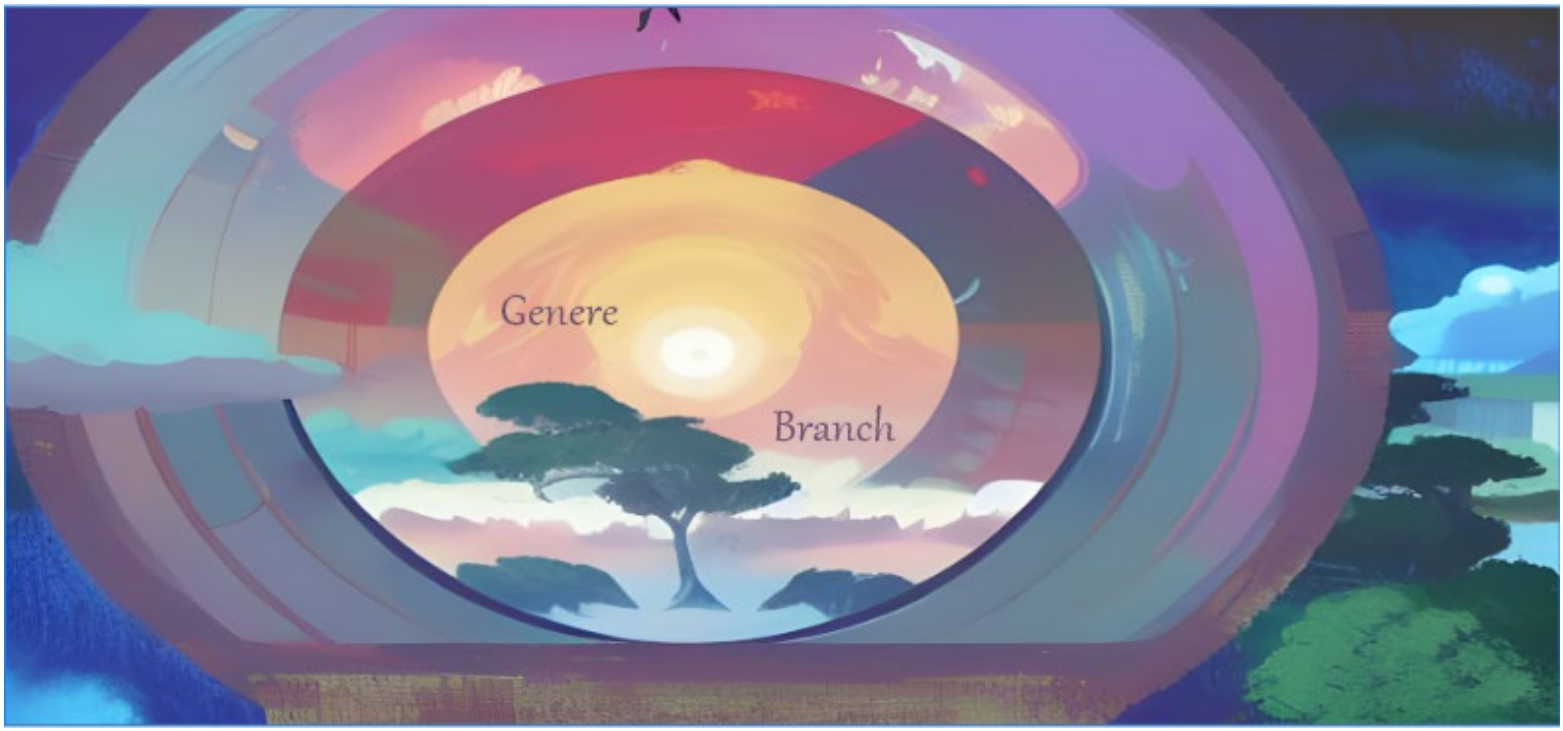
Explore Screen 2: Find objects in the image which match the Latin words. Then drag and drop the word onto the image. When this is accomplished there will be another animation.

Explore Screen 3



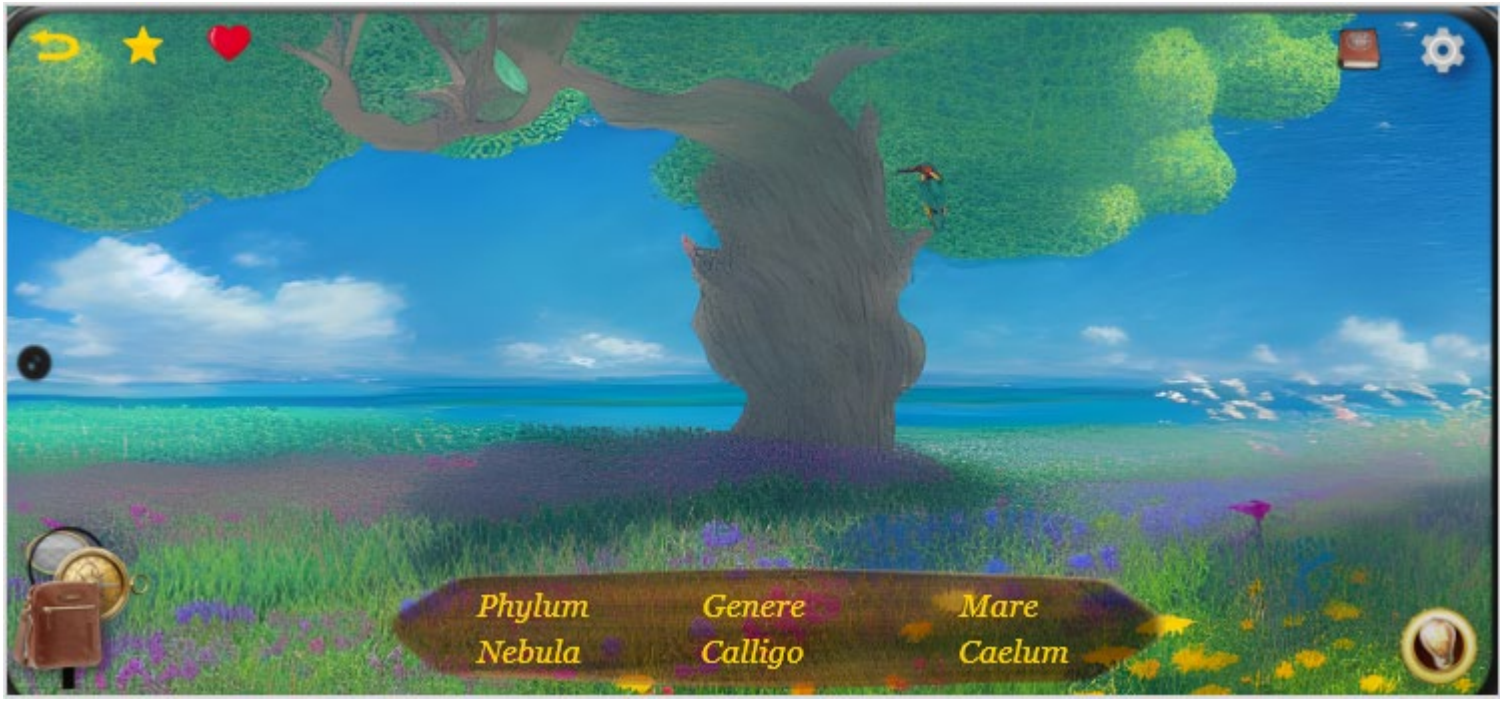
Explore Screen 3: Find objects in the image which match the Latin words. Then drag and drop the words onto the matching images.

Animation after Explore Screen 3



Animation screenshot: After completing Explore Screen 3, an animation appears which reviews the words that were matched.

Explore Screen 4



Explore Screen 4: Find objects in the image which match the Latin words. Then drag and drop the words onto the matching images.

Final Animation



Animation screenshot: After matching all the words on all four screens, an animation appears which reviews all of the words that were matched in this quest.

**Questlist Screen (Players can focus on certain things to learn)

Enable users to set specific learning goals for a tailored experience.



Questlist Screen: After the animation celebrating and reviewing all of the words which were matched correctly, a questlist appears. On this screen the player can choose a new quest which will contain different Latin words to learn.

****Achievements Screen**

There is a structured progression system. Achievements are tracked. Each of these Jewels can have a number for a quest completed.



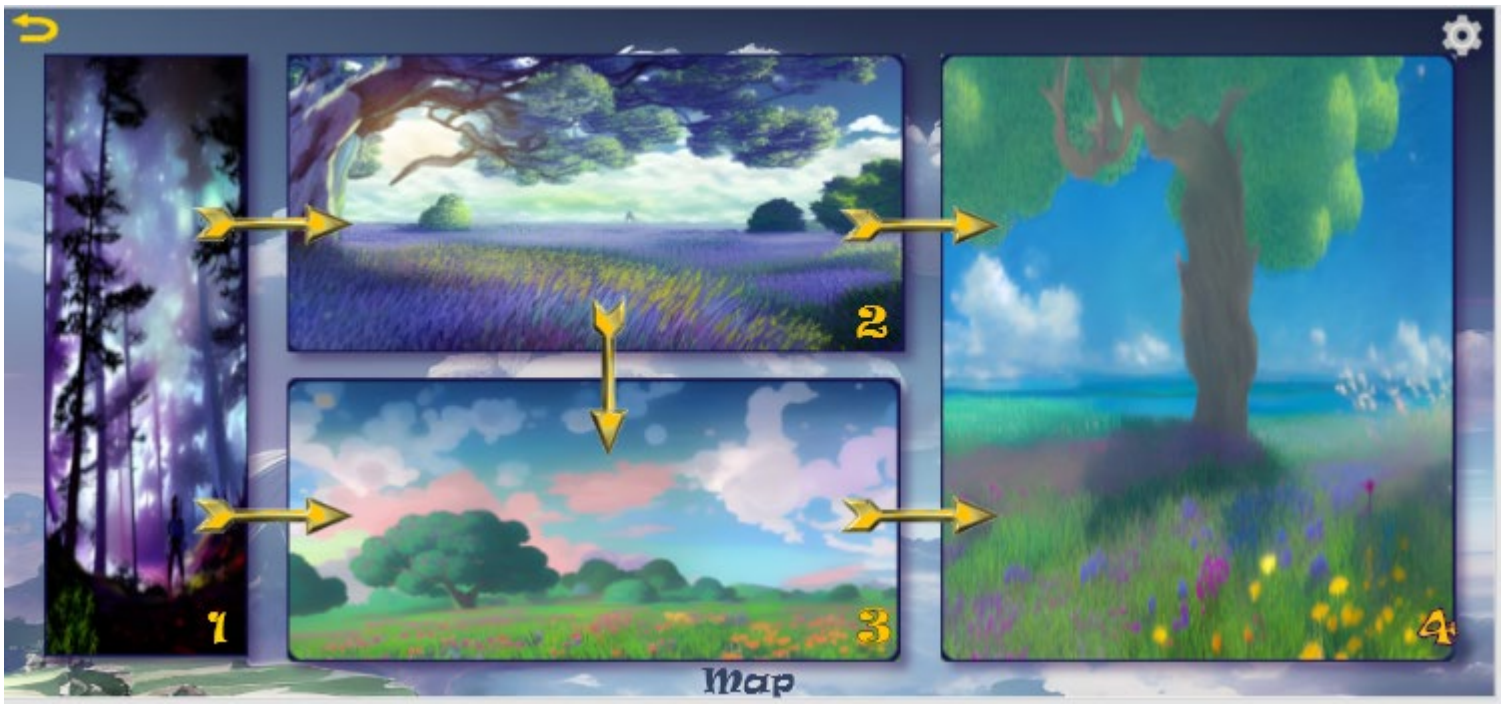
Achievements screen: The user can see what achievement awards they have received while playing the game.

Inventory Screen



Inventory screen: The user can see what is in their game inventory by clicking the bag on the explore screens. Words they have matched correctly will appear in the word-hoard section of the inventory.

Map Screen



Map screen: The player can go to the map screen by clicking the compass on the explore screens. The map shows the user the layout of the screens that they must complete. When the user touches the edge of the explore screens, the arrows appear. On the explore screens, touching the arrow will bring the player to another scene on the map.

Settings Screen



Settings Screen: The user can choose settings for the game from the settings screen.

Available screen background images

